

It may be noted, by the way, that any difficulty which might have been felt as to the apparent coincidence of function between Mazdah and Zarathustra at the Judgement is discounted further by the appearance of other names yet. In *Ys* 43¹² Sraosha comes as angel of judgement—as in the Later Avesta—

followed by treasure-laden Destiny (*Aši*), who shall render to men severally the destinies of the twofold award.

So here, as in many other places, Mazdah's attributes, described as his fellow-Ahuras, perform a function belonging essentially to God in His unity of nature. This is of course sharply differentiated from the sense in which the human teacher acts as judge, as the stanza just cited will itself show when examined as a whole.

Two or three other points may be referred to in connexion with the concept of Judgement. A striking anthropomorphic phrase appears in *Ys* 84⁴, where the separation of "faithful" and "hostile" is made by "the pointings of the hand." If *Ys* 43⁴ (*q.v.*) refers to the same idea, the hand will be that of Mazdah. Reserving for the present some consequences of the central doctrine of the weighing of men's merits and demerits, we may take up the question of the individual judgement, as contrasted with the general. In his review of Stave's book on the influence of Parsism on Judaism,¹ Prof. Söderblom seems to doubt the emergence of this doctrine as early as the Gathic period. I cannot but feel that this goes rather too far. The figure of the Separater contains every-

¹ *Rev. de l'histoire des religions*, xl. 266 ff.

thing essential in the later doctrine of judges who wait by the Bridge; and I should hold rather emphatically that the Judgement is Zarathushtra's own addition to the eschatological picture. The weighing is no doubt an old Iranian idea. It coincides remarkably with the principle of Persian jurisprudence, whereby an accused man was supposed to be judged on his whole record, and a balance of merits might cancel the offence with which he was charged. And if we are right in recognising *Hamistakân* in two passages of the Gathas—on which see p. 174 f.—it seems essential that we should accept the doctrine of judgement in this form as an integral part of Zarathushtra's own system.

From the Bridge the soul of the good man passes into Paradise—according to the Later Avesta through the three heavens of good thought, good word, and good deed. The Gathic name *Garō dāmāna* means “House of Praise”¹: *garō* answers phonetically to the Sanskrit *giras*, genitive of *gīḥ*, and there seems no reason for trying some other equation. Söderblom well compares the fine phrase in Psalm 22⁴. The name is kept up in the Later Avesta (*garōnmāna*) and in Pahlavi, but its implication is nowhere brought out. If Söderblom's parallel from the Ṛgveda (x. 135⁷) is more than accidental—songs and flute are heard in Yama's heaven²—we should suppose that Zarathushtra took over this name of heaven from

¹ Söderblom (*La Vie Future*, 98) makes *mān gairē* in *Ys* 28⁴ an equivalent. This is supported by the Pahlavi tradition and Nerosengh (see Mills, *Gāthās*, 8 f.); but it is difficult to get it out of the text. See the translation below (p. 345), and *AirWb*, 514.

² *Gīrbhiḥ pariṣkṛtaḥ* shows in fact the same word.

Aryan antiquity, and did not lay enough stress on it to give us any expansion of the idea. Whether this be so or not, he seems to have created terms of his own which were more in accord with his trend of thought.¹ He likes to dwell on the word “*best*” (*vahišta*), which ultimately survived all other names for heaven: it may be read in the new Manichæan fragments from Turfan, and in Modern Persian still. The name of the Amshaspand *Vohū* or *Vahištām Manō* describes the paradise where the Best Thought dwells.² It seems fair to claim that Zarathushtra anticipated Marlowe and Milton in the great doctrine that

The mind is its own place, and in itself
Can make a heaven of hell, a hell of heaven.

Sometimes we find “the House of Good Thought” (*Ys* 30¹⁰ *al.*), “the Kingdom of Good Thought” (*Ys* 33⁶), “the Kingdom of blessings” (*Ys* 28⁹), “the Pasture of Good Thought” (*Ys* 33³), “the glorious heritage of Good Thought” (*Ys* 53⁴); and we are told in a fine sentence that the way to it is on “the road of Good Thought, built by Right, on which the Selves of the Future Deliverers shall go to the reward” (*Ys* 34¹³). The language used is not quite free from metaphor. The poet longs to “see

¹ Söderblom, following Darmesteter, would add one to the list which I do not venture to give except in a footnote. In *Ys* 46¹⁶, *varədamqm* was read by the Pahlavi glossator as a compound of *varə* and *dəma*; and Darmesteter rendered duly “Dans la demeure des vœux comblés.” Bartholomae (*Idg. Forsch.*, x. 10) says the Pahlavi is only an “etymologische Spielerei,” which the French savant has taken *au grand sérieux*. He himself makes it an infinitive (Skt *vardhman*): Geldner renders “in seiner Herrlichkeit.” I confess I rather like the *Spielerei*, and sympathise with Söderblom. See *La Vie Future*, 99, and my note on *Ys* 46 *l.c.*

² See below, p. 349, note on *Ys* 30⁴.

Right and Good Thought, the throne of mightiest Ahura and the Obedience (*sraošəm*) of Mazdah" (*Ys* 28⁵). But there clearly cannot be any approach to a spatial conception of the place where the Wise Lord is throned, when "Obedience to Mazdah" comes as its correlative in the next line. Perhaps the nearest approach to localising the Paradise is in *Ys* 30¹—"the felicity that is with the heavenly lights, which through Right shall be beheld by him that wisely thinks." But we need not stay to show that this involves no more real localising than when we speak of "heaven" as the abode of the blessed. The Later Avesta made more of this when it stereotyped the phrase *anayra raocā*, "the Lights without beginning." Yet there too the commoner terms for heaven and hell are *vahištō* and *acištō aṛhuš*, "the Best," "the Worst Existence." The Gathic names for hell are of the same mintage. It is the House of the Lie (*Druj*), and of Worst Thought, the Home of the Dævas, the Worst Existence, and the like. Remorse is the sharpest of the pangs of hell: whoever went on the downward path,

his own thoughts, along that rugged way,
Pursued, like raging hounds, their father and their prey.

But there are more symbols employed here. Hell is full of darkness, sad voices, stench, foul food, and cold. It would seem that the conception of it sprang from the privations of winter on the steppes during the migration southward, when the preciousness of the house-fire made Âtar the very symbol of all that was best for man. For the Iranian, hell and the demons were always in the north. The idea of darkness is the distinguishing feature of the House

of the Lie. It is worked out in the later fancy which conceives the damned so close together that they seemed an indistinguishable mass; yet in the darkness each ever wails, "I am alone!" The symbolism of Fire was kept out of this eschatology for obvious reasons. It was left to the imagination of Milton to combine the symbols:—

A dungeon horrible on all sides round
As one great furnace flamed, yet from those flames
No light, but rather darkness visible.

The picture is quite in the spirit of the Gathas. The basis of the darkness motive was very likely Aryan. In the *R̥gveda* (vii. 104³) hell is a place of darkness in the depths of the earth. We have seen already (p. 128 f.) how the evil spirit was imagined before Zarathushtra to dwell below as "the god underground," in the phrase of Herodotus. The Prophet, then, is using again imagery made ready for him. But as usual he takes care to stamp it with his own hallmark, and make it clear that imagery is only meant to impress ideas that are wholly of the mind.

If ideas of space are left intentionally vague, we soon find that those of time are defined with vivid clearness. There are three different phrases to indicate the duration of future reward and punishment. A typical passage is *Ys* 45⁷.

He whose awards, whereof he ordains, men shall attain
whoso are living or have been or shall be. In eternity
(*aməratāitī*) shall the soul (*urvā*) of the righteous be
happy, in perpetuity (*utayūtā*) the torments of the men of
the Lie. All this doth Mazdah Ahura appoint by his
Dominion.

Here of course we might render "in immortality"; but in *Ys* 48¹ we read:

That which was long since foretold shall be dealt out in eternity to demons and to men.

Amərətūt is capable therefore of meaning simply endless existence. The phrase *yavōi vīspāi*, "to all time," is unmistakable in *Ys* 46¹¹, where it is said of the Karapans and Kavis (pp. 140, 157):

Their own soul and their own Self shall torment them when they come to the Bridge of the Separater. To all time will they be guests for the House of the Lie.

The same phrase is used of the happiness of the righteous. In the light of these two expressions we can hardly doubt that *darəga*, "long," means "eternal" in this connexion. In *Ys* 30¹¹ "long punishment," and 31²⁰ "the future long age of misery, of darkness, ill food, and crying of woe," are as clearly endless as in 33⁵ is the "long life" of him who treads "the straight ways unto Right, wherein Mazdah Ahura dwells." *Utayūiti*, "perpetuity," is another word used of both states: see *Ys* 45⁷, just quoted, and 33⁸.

The future of the righteous and of the wicked is accordingly marked out clearly enough, and the contrast is as that of noon and midnight. So reasonable and practical a thinker was not likely to overlook the fact that a large proportion of men will not easily fall into classes between which there is a great gulf fixed. Since provision was admittedly made for this in later Parsism, the presumption is in favour of the expectation that Zarathushtra would not omit to deal with it. And there are two Gathic passages where the recognition of the Limbo doctrine

seems to suit the language and the context better than anything else. I quote them after Bartholomae, to whom belongs the credit of having first found the key:¹

According as it is with those laws that belong to the present life, so shall the Judge act with most just deed towards the man of the Lie and the man of the Right, and him whose false things and good things balance (*Ys* 33¹: see notes on the passage, p. 358).

Zarathushtra is himself the *Ratu* (Judge) here, though he does not expressly make the claim. Less certain, but with a high degree of probability, is the reference in *Ys* 48⁴:

He who makes his thought now better now worse, and even so his Self by deed and word, who follows his own inclinations, desires, and choices, his place shall be separate according to thy judgement at the last.

The "separate place" here is made explicit in the Later Avestan *misva gātu*, "place of the mixed." It was said to extend from the earth to the stars—was this large allowance intended to suggest that

¹ Prof. Bartholomae draws my attention to an oversight of mine in *ERPP*, 98, by which I assigned the *Priorität* to Roth. As a matter of fact, Roth's well-known paper in *ZDMG*, xxxvii. 223–9, was two years after that of Bartholomae in the same journal (1881), and was written to controvert the criticism of de Harlez. Söderblom (*La Vie Future*, 126) thinks the Dasturs read too much into *Ys* 33¹, and that Zarathushtra thought as little of *Hamistakân* when he wrote it as Paul thought of Purgatory in 1 Cor. 3¹⁵. Dr Casartelli also thinks the doctrine later (*Mazdayasnian Religion*, p. 194 f). But neither he nor Söderblom had before him Bartholomae's treatment of *hāmā-myāsaite* as from *hām* (Skt *sam*, Greek *ἀ-*) and the root *myas*, "mix," cognate with Skt *miçrā*, and ultimately with *misceo* and *μίγνυμι*: see Walde, *Latein. etym. Wörterbuch*², 488. This brings in L.Av. *misvan* and Pahl. *hamistakân* to be etymological as well as semantic associates.

there would be a preponderance of souls that could not be classified as *ašavan* or as *dragvant*? Souls in this limbo only suffered the changes of temperature due to the seasons, and the Regeneration would bring their dubious position to an end. Later speculations of this nature need not be described; but one specimen might be noted, the case of Keresâspa. This hero might have been expected to go to *Garōnmāna* for his exploits in dragon-slaying, related in *Yt* 19³⁸ ff. and elsewhere. But he was unfortunate enough to offend the Fire, by attempting cookery on what seemed an island but was really a sea-monster's back. The monster withdrew into the depths, Âtar suffering extinction in the process; and "the manly-minded Keresâspa fled affrighted," though the Pahlavi commentator assures us that he proved his manly-mindedness by keeping his wits under obviously trying circumstances. It seems a little hard that he should be condemned to limbo for an act so unintentionally disrespectful to the majesty of Fire. The story is worth repeating for the patent contrast it affords to the lines of Zarathustra's thought. His "middling souls" were, we may be sure, determined on more ethical principles; but the scanty indications of the Gathas are not enough to satisfy our curiosity further. It is interesting to compare Plato's treatment of the same problem in the mythus of the *Phædo*, c. 62. Roth compares also a passage in the Koran (Sur. 7) where men of this kind abide on the ridge of the wall separating paradise and hell, content to escape the torments they see on the one side, but full of unquenchable longing for the joys visible on the

other. Milton's Paradise of Fools, located on the outermost "sphere" of the Ptolemaic "world," is another interesting literary parallel.

Some other details in Zarathushtra's eschatology will emerge from the reading of the Gathas as given below. What has been said will suffice for a general picture of his system. Later accretions, consistent or incongruous, may be examined in Söderblom's great monograph, in Casartelli's authoritative account of Sassanian Parsism, and in Böklen's suggestive but too ingenious exposition of parallels between Parsi and Jewish eschatology. A few general observations must suffice here.

Specifically Magian eschatology was probably limited to speculations as to a new heaven and a new earth. We have the authority of Theopompus for their belief in immortality, but even Theopompus is not nearly ancient enough to guarantee his evidence as applying to Magianism apart from the Iranian and the strictly Zarathushtrian elements which they assimilated. Of course, I must admit in my turn that to *prove* the absence of an individual eschatology in original Magianism lies outside the evidence. There is one obvious point of view from which Magianism would naturally come to a belief in immortality. Death is conspicuously the creation of Ahriman, one of whose standing epithets is *pouru-mahrka*, "many-slaying." Even, then, if immortality formed no part of the original doctrine of the Magi—and it seems to me improbable that it did belong to their system before they took up Zoroastrianism—it would be commended to them by their tendency to make the world evenly divided between

the two opposing powers. Light and darkness, health and sickness, knowledge and ignorance, love and hate—these were antitheses necessarily linked with the conception of Ormazd and Ahriman. Life and death could clearly not be omitted; and the certainly Magian notion of the supremely polluting power of a corpse would tend to suggest that the good Spirit must annul that which was so conspicuously the triumph of his foe. This, however, only meant that the Magi accepted immortality, not that they inherited a doctrine based on the analogy of nature, like the unreformed Iranian religion, or like Zarathushtra could contribute original and profound thought to the establishment of the far-reaching conception which was to influence so widely the religious thinking of men. The more characteristically Magian speculations—the flattened earth, the vanishing of shadows, the uniformity of speech, and the like—I have dealt with elsewhere. How far these Magian ideals contribute to the enhancement of happiness in the world that is to be, the reader may judge for himself.

Meanwhile, among the Iranian peoples whose belief in a future life Zarathushtra had inherited and developed, the picturesque and mythical side of the doctrine naturally went on gathering new features. The hints of the Gathas were improved upon—if, indeed, we must not generally say that the Gathas have reduced to mere hints elements of mythus already existing, which in post-reformation days recovered all their old exuberance. For example, the Gathas allude¹ to the nectar and ambrosia—if we

¹ See *Ys* 34¹¹ and note (p. 363).

may translate by familiar terms of another mythology —on which the blessed are to feast in the House of Praise. It is there, as we should expect, a passing symbol, no more to be taken literally than the “fruit of the vine” which Jesus spoke of drinking in the Kingdom of God. In the Later Avesta there is more precision. The climax of the exquisite description of the passage of the soul into the presence of Ahura in the Hadhokht Nask (“Yasht 22”) is the answer from the Throne to the question addressed to the newcomer by one who has arrived before him:—

¹⁶ How didst thou die, O righteous man? How camest thou, righteous man, from homes stocked with cattle and where birds gather and pair (?), from the corporeal world into the spiritual, from the world of perils into that where perils are not? How fell it that the long felicity has come to thee?

¹⁷ Then spake Ahura Mazdah: Ask him not of whom thou art asking, who has come on the awful, painful, distressful path where body and consciousness¹ part asunder. ¹⁸ Let them bring him food of springtide butter: this is the food of the youth² of good thoughts, good words, good deeds, good Self after death; this the food for the woman whose good thoughts, good words, good deeds outweigh (the evil), docile, obedient to the authority,³ after her death.

This *raoyna zaramaya* is evidently the survival of an Aryan concept, seen in the Indian *amṛti* and the Greek and other Indo-European mythologies. As

¹ *Astasca baodanhasca*: cf. the five parts of man as described below, p. 256 f.

² For the *daēnā* has the form of eternal youth, fixed as that of fifteen years old.

³ *Ratu*. In the Later Avesta Bartholomae defines it as the spiritual superior assigned to every creature of Ahura, who has to make the decision in all questions, especially of religion. Sometimes it keeps its older sense of Judge. See *AirWb*, 1498.